BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #15 · MEDICATIONS AND TREATMENT

“The side effects prove nothing will ever work for me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Nausea, drowsiness, weight change, or other effects can make us want to quit. After a bad experience with one medication, we may assume all treatments will fail or be intolerable.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture counsels wisdom and counsel: “Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed.” “Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up.” Side effects are real and deserve a doctor’s attention. They do not mean that no option exists. Doctors can often adjust dose, timing, or type. God works through persistent, honest conversation and wise adjustments.

> *“Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed”* (Proverbs 15:22).

Also see

> “Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up” (Galatians 6:9).

> “The way of a fool is right in his own eyes, but a wise man listens to counsel” (Proverbs 12:15).

> “I lift up my eyes to the hills. From where does my help come? My help comes from the LORD, the Maker of heaven and earth” (Psalm 121:1–2).

> “But those who wait upon the LORD will renew their strength; they will mount up with wings like eagles; they will run and not grow weary, they will walk and not faint” (Isaiah 40:31).

Common self-statements

- This is intolerable.
- Nothing agrees with me.
- I will never find something that works.
- The cure is worse than the illness.
- I am too sensitive.
- I should give up.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing a treatment is either perfect or useless.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that no medicine will work.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling sick and concluding that nothing can help.
- Overgeneralizing: Calling myself impossible to treat.

Challenging questions

- What exactly are the side effects, and how bad are they?
- Have I told my doctor or pharmacist?
- What adjustments or alternatives exist?
- How long did I give it, and what did the doctor advise?

- What would help me cope with side effects in the meantime?
- Who can help me track what happens?

Truth summary

> Side effects are real and worth addressing, but they do not prove that nothing will work. I can talk with my doctor, adjust or switch under supervision, and keep trusting God for wisdom.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Sickness
- Wisdom
- Therapy
- Hopeless
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "The side effects prove nothing will ever work for me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"The side effects prove nothing will ever work for me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What exactly are the side effects, and how bad are they?
- ☐ Have I told my doctor or pharmacist?
- ☐ What adjustments or alternatives exist?
- ☐ How long did I give it, and what did the doctor advise?
- ☐ What would help me cope with side effects in the meantime?
- ☐ Who can help me track what happens?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Plans succeed with many advisers.
- ☐ I can keep seeking.
- ☐ I will not give up.
- ☐ My doctor can adjust.
- ☐ God helps me.
- ☐ There may be other options.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Proverbs 15:22
  "Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed."
- ☐ Galatians 6:9
  "Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up."
- ☐ Proverbs 12:15
  "The way of a fool is right in his own eyes, but a wise man listens to counsel."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Working it out: Each week, note one conversation with your care team and its result.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Proverbs 15:22 becomes: "Sarah can write: "With many advisers, plans succeed.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Wisdom" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Log side effects. Write what happens and when.
- [ ] Call your doctor. Report them promptly.
- [ ] Ask about alternatives. Request options.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 121:1–2. Look to the Lord for help.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "The side effects prove nothing will ever work for me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Working it out
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~The side effects prove nothing will ever work for me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, this treatment is hard on me. Give wisdom to my doctors, patience to me, and hope that there is a path forward. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.